

John Escobedo

Senior QA & UAT Test Lead | Accessibility (508/WCAG) & User-Centered Testing | Healthcare & Government Systems

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(512) 299-3269

Austin, Texas

Summary: Senior QA and UAT lead with 18+ years making software work, and making it work for everyone. I build and lead quality and user-acceptance testing from the ground up, combining technical rigor (test strategy, API and platform testing, JIRA and TestRail, requirements-to-coverage traceability) with deep accessibility expertise (Section 508 and WCAG, hands-on JAWS and NVDA screen-reader validation) and AI-validation skills (LLM output validation, red-teaming, and hallucination detection). Equally central is the human side of quality: I advocate for the end user, communicate clearly with technical and business stakeholders, stay calm and supportive with people under pressure, and bring a trilingual perspective (English, Spanish, and ASL) shaped by years working alongside the Deaf and accessibility community. I test not only whether software functions, but whether it genuinely serves the people who depend on it.

SKILLS

Business Analysis: Requirements Elicitation, User Stories & Acceptance Criteria, Process Mapping & Documentation, Gap Analysis

Leadership & Process: QA Process Implementation, Team Leadership, Process Standardization, SDLC

Testing Methodologies & Frameworks: Agile Testing, Regression Testing, User Acceptance Testing (UAT), Test Planning

AI & Prompt Engineering: Prompt Engineering & Optimization, AI Red Teaming & Adversarial Testing, LLM Output Validation & QA, Hallucination Detection & Fact-Checking

Test Management & Documentation: JIRA/Xray, JIRA Administration, Confluence, TestRail

Accessibility & Inclusive Design: 508 Compliance Testing, WCAG Awareness, JAWS Screen Reader, NVDA Screen Reader

Platforms & Environments: Web Applications, Mobile (iOS/Android), Desktop (PC, Mac, Linux), Cross-browser/Cross-platform

Tools & Technologies: GitHub, Chrome Developer Tools, SQL / JQL, JavaScript/HTML/CSS

Industry Expertise: Healthcare & Telehealth, Gaming & Entertainment, Educational Technology, Live Events & Hosting

Office and Image Suites: Adobe Creative Suite, Office 365: Teams, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, Google Workspace: Drive, Docs, Sheets, Canva

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Tester (Volunteer)

Sharpee.net | Austin, TX (Remote)

March 2026 to Present

Performed exploratory testing on a new web application, found silent-failure bugs that scripted tests missed, and contributed fixes and documentation directly to the codebase.

- Ran end-to-end exploratory testing across browsers and platforms, validating full user workflows.
- Caught silent-failure bugs that scripted tests missed, including cases where the app returned blank responses with no error signal.
- Built a custom failure-report template so any reader, technical or not, could immediately see what broke.

Senior QA Test Lead | Quality Assurance Tester | Scrum Master

GeekSI | Tallahassee, FL

March 2019 to June 2025

Led QA, UAT, and requirements analysis across multiple VA healthcare projects, drove Agile process adoption, and served as SME for complex clinical modules.

- Became the go-to SME for the Traumatic Brain Injury module, running knowledge transfer sessions so cross-functional teams could navigate the clinical requirements.
- Drove the Waterfall-to-Agile transition, introducing code freeze and release-candidate practices that shifted teams from reactive firefighting to predictable delivery.
- Managed test cases, defects, requirements documentation, and project dashboards in JIRA and Confluence across 6+ years and multiple VA projects.
- Ran SOAP API testing on VA home loan .NET applications and REST API testing via Postman on Java healthcare modules, validating service queries, data contracts, and data integrity.
- Built and executed test strategies for VA clinical healthcare applications across .NET and Java, covering UAT, regression, integration, smoke, sanity, end-to-end, and 508 compliance.
- Led 508 compliance initiatives and performed hands-on JAWS and NVDA screen-reader validation on VA clinical interfaces, catching accessibility issues visual inspection misses.
- Partnered with automation engineers to validate Cucumber and Selenium scripts, catching requirement-to-execution gaps before tests went into rotation.
- Built requirements traceability documentation mapping every business need to test coverage across web, mainframe, and mobile.

Senior QA Test Lead | Quality Assurance Tester

EverlyWell | Austin, TX

June 2018 to October 2018

Established QA processes and JIRA workflows from the ground up for a health tech startup's secure patient portal, partnering with engineering and product leadership on release validation.

- As JIRA administrator, designed a unified workflow with custom issue types, permission schemes, notifications, and dashboards, giving engineering and product real-time visibility into release status.
- Defined the initial QA process and release validation criteria for a team shipping without formal quality gates, bringing predictability to a fast-moving startup.
- Assessed release risk and delivered go/no-go recommendations to product and engineering leadership, balancing speed to market with quality.
- Validated releases across major browsers and mobile devices, catching requirement gaps before production.

QA Test Lead | QA Analyst

YouScience | Austin, TX

July 2017 to June 2018

As sole QA, built quality processes and test infrastructure from zero for the flagship education assessment platform, earning trust with development and product teams.

- Introduced foundational quality practices, including version control discipline, release candidates, and structured validation, to a team shipping without formal QA process, integrating quality as a respected part of the SDLC.
- Created end-to-end test and product documentation covering procedures, requirements traceability, verification standards, and feature release notes.
- Standardized user story and acceptance criteria templates, reducing ambiguity between developers and QA and speeding up delivery.
- Owned end-to-end validation for the flagship web application, gating every release across browsers and mobile platforms.

QA Tester | QA Analyst

Luna Data Solutions | Austin, TX

May 2015 to May 2017

QA Analyst contracted to RetailMeNot, coordinating cross-team testing for high-visibility e-commerce launches and aligning test priorities with business needs.

- Coordinated QA across multiple teams for the gift card feature launch supporting a \$22M acquisition, aligning test priorities with leadership expectations.
- Built custom JavaScript tools to validate site-wide analytics implementation and data integrity across the product.
- Triaged live production issues under pressure, communicating status updates to leadership during outages.
- Partnered with developers to improve internal tooling and CI/CD workflow, contributing changes that increased team efficiency.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Test Lead QA Analyst	<i>Communication Services for the Deaf</i>	(2013–2015)
Lead QA Tester Quality Assurance Tester	<i>DocbookMD</i>	(2012–2013)
QA Test Lead QA Tester	<i>Luna Data Solutions</i>	(2011–2012)
Game Master Customer Experience & Trust Specialist	<i>Blizzard Entertainment</i>	(2010–2011)
QA Analyst Support Tools Developer Community Operations	<i>Linden Lab</i>	(2007–2010)
QA Tester	<i>Super Happy Fun Fun</i>	(2006–2007)
QA Test Lead, QA Game Tester	<i>Aspyr Media</i>	(2006–2006)

EDUCATION

Austin Community College - Austin, TX

American Sign Language
2015 – 2017

ASL School - Austin, TX

American Sign Language
2008 – 2012

Vista College - Berkeley, CA

Video Editing and Life Drawing
2001 – 2002

A.I. of Houston - Houston, TX

Fine Art, Typography, Layout, 3D Max
1995 – 1996

San Jacinto College - Pasadena, TX

Computer Science, Fine Art
1993 – 1995

Online version: <https://johnesco.github.io/resume>